UNC, 1975

Same cookies. Rated better when only 2 were left.

@bino_da_producer

Swipe →

134 students rated chocolate chip cookies.

> They were told it was a consumer study.

Some jars held 10. Some held 2.

JAR A

10 cookies

JAR B

2 cookies

The 2-cookie jar won.

> Identical cookies. Rated more desirable when scarce.

Some jars went from 10 to 2 mid-study.

🍪

Start: 10

🔄

Jar swapped

🍪

Now: 2

RESULT 2

"Other raters ate more." Those cookies scored highest of all.

> Even on what they should cost.

Scarcity from other people's demand hits hardest.

10 → 2

the condition rated most desirable

You see this every day.

1. "Only 2 left"
2. "14 people are viewing this"
3. "Selling fast"

Would you want it if there were 100 left?

> Save this for your next checkout.